



Explain how Information Technology can be used in Business

Word processors, spreadsheets, databases, graphics and the integrated office suites of 2026 — their functions, and their effects on the business

TIME	SESSION	MODULE	QUALITY ASSURANCE
90 minutes · Self & Group	Friday, 21 Aug 2026 · 09h00 – 14h00	Module 1 · Professional Team Development	QCTO / MICT SETA

The most common of all computer applications

- Word processing: using a computer to create, edit and print documents — create it, store it electronically, display it on screen, modify it from the keyboard, print or share it.
- The great advantage over a typewriter: change anything without retyping the document — correct, delete, insert and move text freely.
- In 2026 it also saves to the cloud automatically, keeps a version history, and lets several people edit the same document at once.
- The tools a business will meet: Microsoft Word (Microsoft 365, with Copilot), Google Docs (Google Workspace, with Gemini) and the free LibreOffice Writer.

IN BUSINESS

Letters, quotations, contracts, reports, policies, minutes — produced faster and with fewer errors, kept on-brand with templates, finished together in the cloud.

Basic features every word processor supports



Insert text

Add text anywhere in the document.



Delete text

Erase characters, words, lines or pages.



Cut and paste

Remove a section and insert it elsewhere



Copy

Duplicate a section of text.



Page size & margins

Change them — the text re-fits automatically



Search & replace

Find a phrase; swap every occurrence.



Word wrap

New lines start themselves; text re-flows



Print

Hardcopy — or a PDF for email and WhatsApp

TEXT EDITOR OR WORD PROCESSOR?

A program with only these basics is a text editor (Windows Notepad). Word processors that add much more are called full-featured word processors.

What full-featured word processors add



Fonts & layout

Typefaces, bold, italics;
margins and indents;
WYSIWYG.



Headers, footers & numbering

Custom top and bottom of
every page — numbers tracked.



Mail merge

A list plus a template:
personalised letters and labels.



Spell checker & thesaurus

Unrecognised words
highlighted; synonyms built in.



Contents & indexes

Contents, indexes, footnotes,
cross-references —
automated



Macros

Record keystrokes once; replay
them on routine work.

WHAT 2026 ADDS

Track changes and comments · real-time co-authoring with named cursors · Copilot and Gemini drafting, summarising and translating · dictation with automatic punctuation.

SPREADSHEETS

A grid of cells that does the arithmetic for you

- A spreadsheet is a rectangular table (grid) of information, often financial — the name comes from ledgers “spread” across two facing pages.
- Electronic spreadsheets keep the rows, columns and cells but add formulas — =SUM(B2:B13) — and every dependent formula recalculates the instant a number changes.
- Charts, pivot tables and conditional formatting turn the numbers into pictures and summaries.
- The 2026 line-up: Microsoft Excel (Copilot writes formulas and analyses data), Google Sheets (browser, real-time sharing) and the free LibreOffice Calc.

IN BUSINESS

Budgets, cash-flow forecasts, price lists, sales analysis, stock counts, dashboards — and “what if” scenarios tested before money is spent (the decision stages from Lesson 2).

Structured records, queried for answers

- A database is a structured collection of records stored so that a program — or a person using a query language — can consult it to answer questions.
- The DBMS is the software that manages and queries the database; the schema describes the facts it holds and the relationships among them.
- A typical query: “How many burgers with two or more patties were sold in March in region 4?” — the answer is information for a decision.
- The relational model rules (Lesson 2): related tables of rows and columns, linked by shared values.

IN BUSINESS

Customer records (CRM), stock and inventory, sales history, loyalty, payroll, point-of-sale. Questions answered in seconds — and POPIA makes the business guard the personal data it holds.

The database engines of 2026



SQL Server / Azure SQL

Microsoft's engine on-premise and its cloud twin — the corporate mainstay.



PostgreSQL & MySQL

The open-source workhorses behind most of the web's applications.



Oracle Database

The heavyweight of large enterprises, banks and government systems.



MongoDB

A NoSQL store for records that do not fit neatly into tables.



Access & Airtable

Where small businesses start — friendly forms over real databases.



In the cloud

Most new databases run as managed cloud services, not on an office server.

Digitally creating and manipulating visual content



Geometry

Representing and processing surfaces and shapes.



Animation

Representing and manipulating motion.



Rendering

Algorithms that reproduce how light falls on a scene.



Imaging

Image acquisition and image editing.

IN BUSINESS

Logos and branding, adverts, social-media posts, product photos, packaging, signage, slides. A professional image builds trust — and in-house design is fast and cheap.

The 2026 toolbox



Canva

Browser design for posts, flyers and slides.



Photoshop & Illustrator

Pro photo editing and vector art, with Firefly AI.



Figma

Collaborative design in the browser, for teams.



Blender

Free, professional 3D modelling and animation.



CapCut & Premiere Pro

Video editing for adverts and social media.



AI image generation

Firefly, DALL·E and Midjourney draw from a prompt.

An AI-generated artwork, from one sentence

- Generative AI drafts images from a text prompt — describe the visual, refine, and export.
- In business: campaign concepts, product mock-ups and social artwork in minutes instead of days.
- Rules still apply: check licensing, brand fit and honesty before publishing AI-generated visuals.



Théâtre d'Opéra Spatial — generated with Midjourney by Jason M. Allen; it won a Colorado State Fair art competition in 2022 and started a worldwide debate.

Microsoft 365 — one subscription, tools that work together

- An office suite bundles the word processor, spreadsheet, presentations and email — one look and feel, one spell checker, live links between applications.
- Live links keep work current: an Excel chart pasted into a Word report updates when the numbers change.
- Office began in 1989 (Mac) and 1990 (Windows) as Word + Excel + PowerPoint. Today it is Microsoft 365 — a cloud subscription priced per user per month.
- A 2026 business subscription: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, OneNote, Teams, OneDrive and SharePoint — with Copilot woven through all of them.

IN BUSINESS

A quotation drafted in Word, costed in Excel, presented in PowerPoint, shared in Teams and signed off the same day — on desktop, browser, tablet or phone.

The rest of the 2026 market



Google Workspace

Docs, Sheets, Slides, Gmail, Drive, Meet with Gemini — browser-first, collaboration is its superpower.



LibreOffice

Free, open-source, fully offline — Writer, Calc, Impress and Base. Opens Microsoft formats.



iWork · Zoho · OnlyOffice · WPS

Apple's suite plus capable challengers — all read and write the standard formats.

COMPATIBILITY IS WHAT MATTERS

.docx, .xlsx and .pptx are the de facto exchange standards; PDF is the standard for final documents. Weigh cost, collaboration, connectivity and staff skills.

The suites that came before — and what they teach

Suite	What it bundled	What happened
Lotus SmartSuite	Word Pro · 1-2-3 · Freelance Graphics · Approach · Organizer	Discontinued — 1-2-3 ended in 2013
Corel WordPerfect Office	WordPerfect · Quattro Pro · Paradox	Survives only in a small legal niche
CorelDRAW	Vector graphics (still Corel's best-seller)	Lives on — as a graphics tool, not a suite

THE LESSON

Compatibility beats features. Users would not leave the formats everyone else used — the same reason .docx and .xlsx still rule in 2026.

Function and effect — what you must be able to explain

Application	Function — what it does	Effect — what it changes
Word processors	Create, edit and share documents	Faster, error-free, on-brand paperwork
Spreadsheets	Calculate, analyse and chart numbers	Accurate arithmetic; “what if” before money moves
Databases	Store and query business records	Facts on demand; one trusted copy of the truth
Graphics	Create the visual face of the business	Professional image at low in-house cost
Integrated suites	Bundle it all with email and cloud files	One subscription; data flows, skills transfer

Your work for Lesson 3



Questioning session

45 minutes · Self & Group — explain each application's functions AND effects. AI-marked on the Exercises tab.



Slide quizzes

Every section gates on its five questions — all correct unlocks Next.



Self assessment

“I am able to explain how IT can be used in business” — tick it honestly.



Logbook project — Research

Show how IT is used in everyday business, with articles and pictures. Mark it 114050.



IT is how a business writes, counts, remembers and shows itself.

Word processors for the paperwork · spreadsheets for the numbers · databases for the records · graphics for the brand · one integrated suite tying it all together — always explain the function AND the effect.